

Jacoby Two Notrump

A 2NT response to a Major sit opening promises at least 4-card support and at least opening hand strength. It is absolutely forcing to game.

Opener's second bid describes her hand further:

4 of the Major shows a minimum featureless hand

3NT shows extra strength and a 5-card trump suit

3 of the Major shows extra strength and a 6+ card trump suit

3 of any other suit shows shortness (singleton or void)

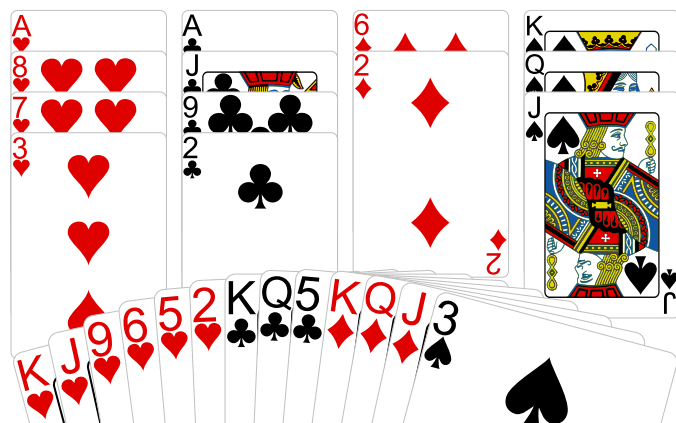
4 of any other suit shows a second 5-card suit

Splinter Bids

A double-jump-shift as a response to partner's opening 1 of a Major suit is a Splinter bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least four card support for the Major, and a singleton or void in the "splintered" suit. It is absolutely forcing to game.

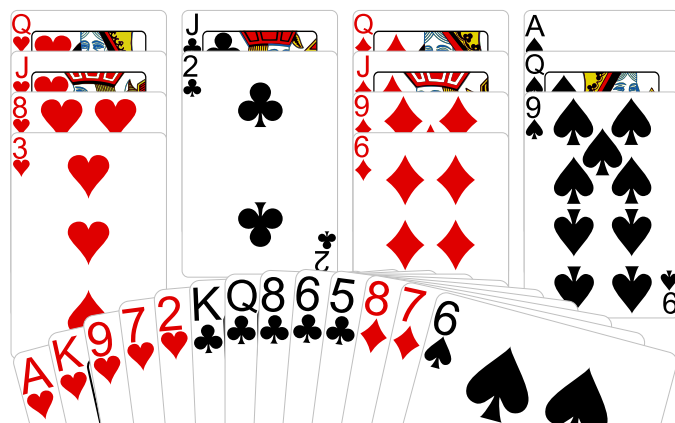
BakerBridge has complete lessons for these conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 5♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



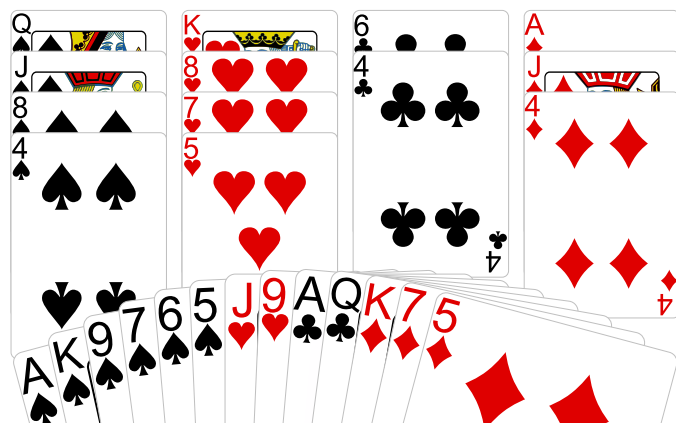
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



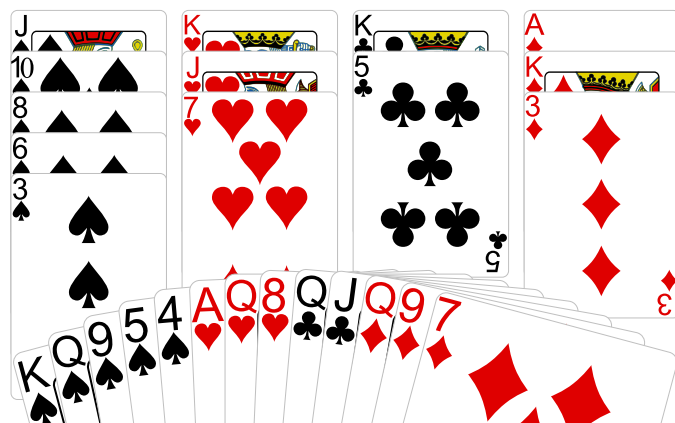
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 5♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 5♥

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 5♠

Declarer: West

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 8 7 6 4
 ♥ -
 ♦ 9 7 4 3
 ♣ 8 7 4

15
 4 6
 15

♠ 3
 ♥ K J 9 6 5 2
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ K Q 5



♠ K Q J
 ♥ A 8 7 3
 ♦ 6 2
 ♣ A J 9 2

♠ T 5 2
 ♥ Q T 4
 ♦ A T 8 5
 ♣ T 6 3

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
All Pass			
5♥ by North			

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NORTH bids 3♠ to show a strong hand with a singleton ♠.

After SOUTH shows her first-round ♣ control NORTH decides he will bid slam if SOUTH has three Aces.

When Blackwood reveals just two Aces in SOUTH, NORTH stops at 5



Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A Q 9
♥ Q J 8 3
♦ Q J 9 6
♣ J 2

8
13 12
7

♠ K J 7 4 3
♥ 5 4
♦ A T 5
♣ 9 4 3



♠ T 8 5 2
♥ T 6
♦ K 4 3 2
♣ A T 7

♠ 6
♥ A K 9 7 2
♦ 8 7
♣ K Q 8 6 5

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

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EAST bids 4♣ after WEST's Jacoby 2NT. The reason for this bid is just to describe

her hand as having a side 5-card ♣ suit. EAST knows the eventual contract will

be some level of

♥

s.

WEST doesn't have a strong hand, but he would show

♦

control at

this time if he had the Ace. He isn't strong enough to go past game to show the ♠A, so he

just bids 4

♥

.

Deal 3

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 2
♥ T 4 3 2
♦ Q T 9 8 6
♣ K J 2

11
6 6
17

♠ Q J 8 4
♥ K 8 7 5
♦ A J 4
♣ 6 4



♠ A K 9 7 6 5
♥ J 9
♦ K 7 5
♣ A Q

♠ T 3
♥ A Q 6
♦ 3 2
♣ T 9 8 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

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NORTH should not be tempted to use Jacoby 2NT with this hand. There are only 12 points, and

the Limit Raise is a perfect way to show a 12 point support hand.

SOUTH has more than enough strength to bid game after NORTH's limit raise. If NORTH had

mistakenly used a Jacoby 2NT response, SOUTH would probably have tried to reach slam,

and perhaps gotten too high.

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 9 5 4
 ♥ A Q 8
 ♦ Q 9 7
 ♣ Q J

5
 16 15
 4

♠ A 2
 ♥ 9 5 4 3 2
 ♦ J 4
 ♣ 9 8 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7
 ♥ T 6
 ♦ T 8 6 5 2
 ♣ A T 7 3 2

♠ J T 8 6 3
 ♥ K J 7
 ♦ A K 3
 ♣ K 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT	Pass	4 ♦	Pass
4 ♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5 ♦	Pass	5 ♠	
All Pass			
5 ♠ by West			

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WEST bids 3NT to show a good hand with five ♠s.

EAST shows his

♦

control, and WEST then shows her

♥

control.

A final check with Blackwood shows two Aces missing. Too bad.

Deal 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 3
 ♥ T 6 4
 ♦ A T 5 3
 ♣ 8 7 4 3

16
 4 5
 15

♠ A Q 8 7 5 2

♥ A 3

♦ J 6 2

♣ K Q



♠ K J 9 6

♥ K Q 9 8

♦ Q 9 4

♣ A 5

♠ 4

♥ J 7 5 2

♦ K 8 7

♣ J T 9 6 2

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NORTH shows his 6-card ♠ suit by bidding 3♠.

SOUTH shows her ♣ control and NORTH shows his

♥

control,

but it seems neither has a control in

♦

s.

So they stop in game.

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			